

FDS0 Self-Assessment

This is a quick check of where you stand before Week 1. There is no right answer; your mentor uses your ticks to decide which sessions to move faster through and which to walk through more slowly. Tick the boxes you are already comfortable with; leave the rest blank.

English proficiency

Native or near-native; I read FDS materials at full speed.
Fluent; I read technical English without help, occasional oral clarification welcome.
Intermediate; I can follow short technical English; longer passages take effort.
Basic; I will need my mentor to explain most technical English in another language.

CLI and OS (Seminars 4, 5)

I use Linux or macOS as my daily OS, or have WSL set up on Windows.
I open a terminal regularly.
I edit files in a terminal editor (vim, nano, micro, ...) without thinking about it.
I navigate the filesystem with `cd`, `ls`, `pwd`, and tab completion.
I copy, move, and delete files from the shell (`cp`, `mv`, `rm`, `mkdir`).

Markdown (Seminar 5)

I know how to open and read a `.md` file (in a viewer or a text editor).
I write Markdown documents (headings, lists, links, inline code, fenced code blocks).
I am comfortable with advanced features (tables, footnotes, math via MathJax/KaTeX, syntax-highlighted code blocks, front matter).

Git and GitHub (Seminars 7, 8)

I have Git installed locally with my author identity configured.
I make commits and read `git diff` comfortably.
I have opened a pull request on GitHub.
I have reviewed someone else's pull request and left a substantive comment.

LaTeX (Seminars 10, 11)

I have compiled a `.tex` file to PDF.
I am comfortable writing equations with `equation` or `align`.
I use `\label` and `\ref` for cross-references.
I have built a Beamer slide deck.

Logic (Seminar 9)

I can name the difference between a claim, a premise, and evidence.
I read academic arguments and can pick them apart structurally.

AI agents (Seminars 12, 13)

I have used a chat LLM (ChatGPT, Claude, etc.) for real work.
I have used an AI coding assistant (Copilot, Claude Code, Cursor, ...).
I already have a stable access path to an AI service I trust.

Background (free text)

Languages you can write fluently (helps your mentor decide which language to use for oral explanations):

Programming languages you are comfortable with:

Anything else your mentor should know: